

Crypto Content Creators

Crypto Content Creators Segment

TLDR:

Crypto content creators prioritize growth, credibility, and control over an “everything app.” Base currently feels cluttered, overly similar to Twitter/Threads, and risky due to over-tokenization. Creators lack a clear incentive to migrate their audience. To attract this segment, Base must 1) clarify its value proposition, 2) simplify onboarding and clearly communicate the tokenization process, and 3) build creator-first features that protect attribution and make growth and earnings visible.

Key Recommendations:

1. **Clarify a narrow value proposition:** Position Base as the best place for Web3 creators to grow their audience, build a professional reputation, and access crypto-specific tools that don’t exist on Twitter (on-chain provenance, less governance and transparent policies). Will verify value proposition through A/B tests across the entire app, in order to highlight specific Web3 and Base features
2. **Guided onboarding flow:** Each target segment (Creators, Consumers, and Crypto-Curious users) should experience a unique onboarding experience to understand specific app features that pertain to them. For Creators specifically, they should understand *what to do first, how to publish/coin content, how to be discovered and expand, and where to see growth and earnings*, to drive app retention
3. **Clearly identify the value of tokenization:** Emphasize and enforce scarcity, built-in attribution, anti-plagiarism, and innovation. Users should know, subconsciously, that these tokens are limited, rare, and valuable. Employ simple tools to educate creators on how tokenization works and show how this model can outperform traditional social media monetization
4. **Build a creator dashboard:** Centralize analytics on audience growth, engagement, earnings trends, and token performance. This can demonstrate how Web3-native data works in the creator’s favor, and provide actionable insights to improve strategy.
5. **De-prioritize novelty features:** Treat ini-apps (games, chatbots) as a supplement to other features, but not a distraction from the core value. Depriorize novelties and favor tools with long-term utility, such as LLM-powered creator tools and creator discovery features.

Methodology:

Goal: Understand how crypto-native content creators perceive the Base app, how they compare it to existing platforms (especially Twitter), and what they need in order to adopt Base as a primary channel.

Participants: 5 interviews with Web3-native creators (long-time Coinbase/Base users, active on Twitter and crypto communities), plus review of existing persona docs, UX maps, and prior user quotes from earlier semester's research.

Interview 1: Senior – NYU Economics & Data Science, Content Creator and Analyst

Has interned at two crypto companies (including DeFi yield rebalancing) and runs a Twitter account for a Polygon-focused accelerator. Uses social platforms to understand high-level trends, network with builders, and is very sensitive to plagiarism and lack of attribution in Web2 feeds.

Interview 2: Sophomore – NYU, Crypto-Native Polymarket / Web3 Social User

Has used Coinbase Wallet/Base for around 5 years. Treats platforms as infrastructure for fast, insights on markets, and prefers niche and authentic platforms.

Interview 3: Junior – NYU Computer Science

Prior software development and trading internship experience. Splits time between Crypto Twitter, TikTok, and Instagram. Gravitates toward products which enable quick trading, monitoring sentiment, and exploring up-and-coming apps and projects.

Interview 2: Sophomore – NYU Economics, Trader

Primarily uses a single platform to both trade and consume content. Enjoys summarized content to inform trading decisions rather than engaging in long-form media consumption.

Final Insights:

Insight 1: Creators don't understand what exactly the app is for. The home experience involves many ideas at once with no clear path, contributing to a harmful first impression. Because of this, users default to apps with more clearly defined value propositions as they know why they are there.

- The only user to comment that onboarding was “seamless” was a user who already had the Coinbase Wallet app downloaded and is crypto-native; for an average user, “there was no tour” and it was “overwhelming all at once.”
- “It looks clean but there's way too much going on... who would use this? Honestly the average crypto user wouldn't download this... Twitter already does the job better.”

Opportunity:

- Introduce **3 overall onboarding paths** and clearly communicate value proposition. For the creator-specific onboarding path: “Start here, walk through posting → minting the token → introduce royalty model → seeing results.”
- Use a short, skippable tour that highlights 3 things:
 1. How to post or “coin” content

- Include cost of creation (example: 0.01 SOL first buy fee, 0.005 SOL gas fee, recommended extra for future transactions)
 - Transparent transaction fee (how do fees scale by market cap?)
 - How to name ticker and add an image for the coin
2. Where to see performance (dashboard). This is key in differentiating Base from Twitter—on-chain reputation, attribution, and access to Web3-specific analytics tools should be highlighted here.
- Progressively reveal additional features. If other multi-faceted social media apps such as Instagram launched posts, stories, reels and livestreams all at once, users would be overwhelmed and unable to gradually build trust and adapt from previous apps

Insight 2: Creators worry that turning every post into a token dilutes value. They want their content to feel scarce and meaningful. Tokenization is seen as a risk (pump-like, speculative) rather than a benefit to their content creation, brand and community, especially when plagiarism and trend-based content is

- “If everything can be coined, nothing feels valuable.”
- “Thinks they’re just making NFTs out of everything... over time it will just dilute everything... it’s a glorified pump fund... you’re essentially buying tweets.”
- “A normal person wouldn’t buy someone else’s Twitter profile, so why would you buy someone’s Zora profile?”

Opportunity:

- Introduce clear rules for scarcity (e.g., limited editions, time-boxed drops) and communicate why a piece is special.
- Emphasize anti-plagiarism and attribution as a core value of Base. Develop automatic crediting, visible provenance, and communicate tools that flag copied content.
- Communicate trust and integrity in tokenization to differentiate from pump-style models.

Insight 3: Professional reputation, reach, and reliable revenue models matter more than owning tokenized posts. Users are used to sponsorship and commission structures (via TikTok, Twitter, and external brand deals) and see more upside in that model than in selling ownership of content.

- Starbucks analogy: selling the logo creates long-term liability; sponsoring creators to promote it increases brand value without giving up the asset.
- “Tweets only last 12 hours... you’d essentially be undervaluing a tweet by adding ownership.”
- “You might as well keep the asset and pay people to promote it and further increase the value of the brand.”

Opportunity:

- Introduce a creator monetization layer
 - On-chain sponsorships/brand campaigns

- Introduce profile reputation infrastructure: verified, on-chain track record, featured creators
- Should expose simple on-chain primitives like creating a campaign, setting budgets, and matching businesses with relevant creators

Insight 4: Mini-apps catch the eye at first, but feel disconnected from overall creator goals.

- “Wordle was fun but didn’t give me a reason to keep coming back. Novel, but not long term features do not retain utility.”

Opportunity:

- Follow NYT/LinkedIn Games strategy: create incentive to return to play 3-5 limited daily crypto games
- Incorporate sharing mechanics

Crypto-Curious Explorer

Crypto-Curious Explorer Segment

TL;DR: Crypto-Curious Explorers want simple, low-risk ways to learn Web3, but the current experiences are perceived as noisy, confusing, and low-trust. Their core needs are a clearer discovery path, faster understanding of what the app does, contextual education that reduces perceived risk, and visible social proof that validates safety and relevance. By reducing cognitive load, guiding the “first mile,” explaining actions in context, and highlighting peer activity, we can convert cautious learners into active Base users.

Key Recommendations:

- 1. Customized Discovery Feed:** Cluttered, high-effort experiences quickly lose minimalist users; use signals (interests, past actions, community trends) to eliminate the “random feed” feeling.
- 2. Day-1 Quickstart:** Users churn early because the app doesn’t tell them where to go or why; introduce an optional brief interactive walkthrough of core features upon first login (e.g., “how to content coin a post?”)
- 3. Tap-to-Understand ("Learn-Before-Earn"):** Users won’t spend or transact because they don’t feel secure yet; integrate contextual tooltips that explain Web3 primitives (e.g., "Why tokenize this?") at the moment of action.
- 4. Proof-of-Peers:** Peer activity is a prerequisite for engagement; visibly display friend activity and trusted community usage stats within the discovery flow (e.g., "5 people you follow interacted with this in the past 24h").

Methodologies:

- **Goal:** Identify friction points and trust gaps that are preventing the conversion of "crypto-curious explorers" into active Base users.

- **Participants:** Conducted 4 in-person interviews with NYU blockchain and fintech club mentees, who are early-career professionals seeking investment upside or career growth. They are 18–24-year-olds students and young professionals with limited crypto experience. They want simple, low-risk ways to learn Web3 and try DApps before investing. Clean UX, guidance, and social proof pull them in; complexity pushes them out. With clear trust signals, they quickly shift from cautious learners to active promoters.

Key Findings:

1. Overload and clutter make minimalists disengage fast; curate the experience to surface high-signal value immediately.

Users perceive the current feed as a mix of low-quality content and unstructured DApps, leading to immediate decision fatigue. Users perceive the app as a "Web3 Mall" without a map, where the burden of finding value is placed on the user. Since "crypto-curious explorers" prioritizes simple and low-risk engagement, this lack of relevance signals that the platform is cluttered and low-value, causing them to disengage before finding the features that matter. A Customized Discovery Feed is suggested to tailor the user experience.

- "Too much. Minimalism is better."
- "It is easy to look at the app and think there is 'way too much going on'"

Opportunity: Implement a Customized Discovery Feed that uses signals (interests, past actions) to eliminate the "random feed" feeling.

2. Lack of guidance slows users from grasping what the app does; guide them through the "First Mile" to prevent drop-off.

The current landing experience assumes users already know what to do, dropping them into a broad ecosystem without context or direction. This "open exploration" approach backfires for new users, who report significant confusion about the app's primary utility within the first few minutes of usage. Without a structured introduction to key actions, like creating a wallet or posting content, users feel aimless and abandon the session before establishing a habit. A Day-1 Quickstart is suggested to lower this learning curve and define a clear path to the "first win."

- "It took me a minute or two to understand what it was."
- "Opening up to a Discover page was a bit confusing... I wasn't sure where to go first."

Opportunity: Introduce a Day-1 Quickstart, which is an optional, interactive walkthrough of core features upon first login.

3. Risk aversion prevents monetization; contextualize financial primitives to build the trust required for conversion.

Users frequently hesitate to engage with core monetization features like "Launch Coin" or "Tokenizing" because they perceive them as complex financial risks rather than social interactions. The interface

currently demands money (or assets) without explaining the value proposition, creating a "trust gap" that cautious users refuse to cross. They need to understand the mechanisms and the utility before they commit capital. Tap-to-Understand features bridge this gap by delivering just-in-time education that frames these actions as safe, logical steps rather than blind gambles.

- "I'm not the type of person who's going to go buy... unless it's for a pure investment."
- "I didn't really grasp the innovation behind content tokenization."

Opportunity: Deploy Tap-to-Understand tooltips that explain Web3 primitives (e.g., "Why tokenize this?") at the moment of action.

4. Peer activity is a prerequisite for engagement; leverage peer signals to overcome the cold start problem.

For this cohort, the value of the platform is strictly derived from the network effect. They will not adopt a new tool if it feels like a "ghost town." The current lack of visible friend activity or community usage stats makes the environment feel empty and unsafe, triggering a wait-and-see attitude that prevents activation. By failing to show that others are successfully using the platform, we lose the most powerful lever for adoption: social proof. Highlight peer activity to signal that the ecosystem is alive and safe to join.

- "My usage depends entirely on whether others are on the platform, if friends use it, I will too."
- "I wouldn't use it independently unless guided."

Opportunity: Utilize Proof-of-Peers to visibly display friend activity and trusted community usage stats within the discovery flow, such as "Your Fintech Club peers are using this DApp", "2 friends just joined this community", "5 people you follow interacted with this in the past 24h", and "Most engaged DApp this week on Base".